a choker is someone who doesn't have the stomach or nerve for the big game. The situation is immensely frustrating for me, because I'm exactly the opposite. I live for the big games – these are the games that motivate me to perform at my best. At the end of the day, experience means nothing if you can't handle big-game pressure.

So, are the Proteas chokers? I'm not saying that it's right that we have been given that label, but I think it's a an accurate assessment of some situations the team has been in.

Hey, but that's way too miserable a note on which to end my World Cup recollections, isn't it? Which is why I've saved this little cameo for the end …

Six sixes

There was one upside to the 2007 World Cup, and it happened in one particular over I faced against Daan van Bunge of the Netherlands. In previous World Cups I tended to play within myself to start off with, and then I turned it on towards the end. When I scored 143 against New Zealand in 2003, for example, Eric Simons had said to me, 'I know you're in really good nick at the moment, but I'd like to see you get a scratchy 50 today against New Zealand.' I could easily have been out once or twice, but I did scratch my way to 50 … and then turned on the taps to get 100 … and then 143.

But this group game against the Dutch was another story. For one, I had the luxury of knowing that we were going to get a big total anyway – Jacques Kallis was purring along and would end up scoring 128 off 157 balls – and even though they had shocked the English at the start of the tournament, the Dutch didn't have enough firepower to worry us. For another, the straight boundaries on this pitch at Basseterre in St Kitts were pretty short, and right from the start of my innings, therefore, I decided to have a proper go.

It wasn't as if I had taken a particular liking to Daan van Bunge's spin-bowling either. I think I was just going to try to smash every ball irrespective of who the bowler was. I also wasn't thinking I would hit six sixes from the outset; the idea only entered my head after I'd clocked the first two.

For the first six, I charged down the wicket and hit the ball over long-on. For the second six, I moved up the pitch again and this time smacked it over